

Followers for sale

Twitter followers can be bought – 1,000 for \$5-\$20. Finding legitimate sellers is another issue altogether <http://dgit.in/14aQcYJ>



Nesting tweets

A new service called Nestivity launched its software that is entirely Twitter-based. The service will help brands create a sense of community <http://dgit.in/155ItuL>



The touchscreen Braille phone

them into 'touchable' patterns", he said.

A prototype of the smartphone was developed by Dagar in collaboration with IIT Delhi. It has been in development since the past two years at LV Prasad Eye Institute in Hyderabad. The Braille smartphone is expected to roll out by the end of 2013 and will be priced around the ₹10,000 mark. The display uses 'Shape Memory Alloy' technology, which is based on the concept that metals remember their original shapes i.e expand and contract to their original shape after use. This screen will be capable of elevating and depressing the contents to form patterns in Braille. The phone's 'screen' has a grid of pins, which will move up and down as per requirement.

Google Releases Glass Tech Specs

In a flurry of releases, Google has revealed the specifications of the Glass hardware, elaborated on policies for third-party Glass developers and made the Mirror API documentation available along with Glassware sample code. It has also announced that Explorer Editions were being produced; launched the MyGlass companion app and added a setup and help page for Glass users.

The juiciest reveal was the announced specifications of Google Glass hardware. The AR spectacles will tout a tiny display that will deliver to the eye an apparent image equivalent to a 25-inch HD display eight feet away. Glass will also sport a 5MP camera capable of 720p video recording, and feature 16GB built-in storage space (12 GB of which is user available).

Google Glass doesn't feature 3G/2G connectivity, so you'll have to tether it to your Android smartphone for all carrier-based calls, data transfer, messaging, and synchronization. It does feature 802.11 b/g Wi-Fi and Bluetooth connectivity, apart from a microUSB port for transfer and charging.

Audio will be transmitted via bone conduction, and the Google Glass spectacles will be available in a one-size-fits-all design, adjustable with different nose pieces. The Glass spectacles would be compatible with Bluetooth-enabled phones, but to use all features (such as GPS and SMS) along with the MyGlass app, Android devices running on v4.0.3 Ice Cream Sandwich or higher are required.

As for Explorer Editions of Google Glass, the company



Glass cannot be used by anyone but you

has emailed the 2,000 or so developers that signed up for the Glass Explorers program, informing them that their units have begun rolling off production lines.

Google has also released the terms of service for the Google Mirror API, which includes several interesting details, the biggest of which is that there will be "No ads." Interestingly, user data usage was also strictly controlled, with the company stating: "You may not use user data from your API Client for advertising purposes/" Developers will also not be able to "access, update, use or share API content without displaying the content or a summary to the end user."

Google, in its Glass Explorer Edition ToS, also said: "You may not resell, loan, transfer, or give your device to any other person. If you resell, loan, transfer, or give your device to any other person without Google's authorization, Google reserves the right to deactivate the device, and neither you nor the unauthorized person using the device will be entitled to any refund, product support, or product warranty."

Each Google Glass sold will be associated with the user's Google account, and that is how Google will know whether you've loaned or resold the Glass to anyone. If caught, Google will simply flip the switch and brick your \$1,500 toy.

Mozilla CEO Defends Firefox OS

Mozilla CEO Gary Kovacs defended his decision to launch the Firefox Mobile OS in a market that already has established names such as iOS and

Android by stating that budget users would warm up to the idea of having a phone with a connected OS. While speaking at a Dive Into Mobile conference in New York, Kovacs said that the popularity of existing mobile operating systems was mainly because of high-end devices. The Firefox OS will target low-end phones in countries where their need is better appreciated and also

where Firefox has brand recognition.

Kovacs then spoke about the launch schedule



Would you buy the Firefox OS?

of Firefox OS handsets with Brazil, Colombia, Hungary, Mexico, Montenegro, Poland, Serbia, Spain and Venezuela being the first few countries where it will be launched. However, Mozilla was unable to reveal the exact launch dates of the handsets.

Kovacs also reiterated the advantage held by Firefox OS because of its reliance on the open HTML5 standard. Kovacs said that improvements in HTML5 meant that developers could work with better graphics hardware, javascript performance and APIs. Kovacs also said that he was optimistic of a respectable user base forming for Firefox OS as he didn't think only two ecosystems would be sufficient as more and more users decided to go online with their phones. **4**